

HELMET HEAD

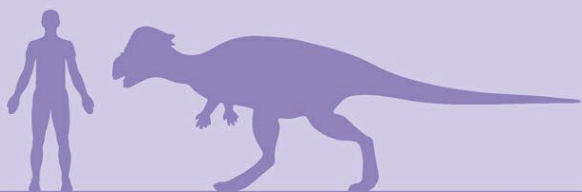
PACHYCEPHALOSAURUS

***Pachycephalosaurus* roamed North America** in the Late Cretaceous Period. Although its fossils are rare and no complete skeleton has been found, paleontologists have found enough evidence to show that *Pachycephalosaurus* was a strong, two-legged dinosaur. It had a thick, bony dome on its skull, which it used as a weapon in its clashes with rivals over mates or territory. *Pachycephalosaurus* had an unusual variety of teeth, suggesting that it might have occasionally snacked on insects or lizards, as well as vegetation.

Sturdy, four-toed hind legs supported the weight of this mid-sized animal.

AT A GLANCE

- **LENGTH** 16½ ft (5 m)
- **LIVED** 70–66 MYA
- **DIET** Omnivore
- **HABITAT** Subtropical floodplains and forests



Butting heads

Pachycephalosaurus probably used its bony, armored head to fight off rivals. The skull was made of a unique type of bone that healed quickly, although paleontologists have found a skull showing the signs of an infected injury.

